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Technology Risk Advisor

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 16th August 2026



Government
Digital Service

Reference number

474069

Salary

£45,020 - £56,355

£45,020 £53,620 (Bristol & Manchester) £47,755 - £56,355 (London)
Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £47,355 for London and £44,620 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

Government Cyber Unit

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Cyber Unit's mission is to protect public services from cyber threats and digital resilience failures. We are working to achieve a step change in our cyber and digital resilience across government, through delivery of the Government Cyber Action Plan, and working closely with departments and national technical authorities including the National Cyber Security Centre to deliver. This is a challenging time to be working in cyber security and digital resilience, but we have an incredible opportunity to make a difference to people's lives and promote national security by protecting the public services and national infrastructure they rely on. We work at the forefront of shaping the UK's national response to emerging cyber and technology issues - from the increasingly complex range of state-sponsored cyber-attacks and supply chain compromises, through to the transformational benefits and security challenges of frontier AI and quantum computing.

We are committed to creating an inclusive and supportive working environment where people can learn, develop and do their best work. Continuous professional development and a focus on wellbeing is core to our unit culture. We welcome applications from candidates who share this ethos and are excited by our mission.

We're part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

You will be joining the Technology Risk team, part of the Cyber Accountability Deputy Director area, helping to drive consistent, effective technology risk management across government. The Technology Risk team works across central teams and departments to improve how technology risks are identified, understood and acted on - using frameworks, data and targeted engagement to drive accountability and investment.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation's highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

Job description

We are hiring two roles to support the development and operation of the cross government Technology Risk Framework and Technology Risk Appetite. The postholder helps maintain government's understanding of significant technology risks through research, analysis, governance support and stakeholder engagement, ensuring risk information is accurate, accessible and available to support decision making.

If you're motivated by national-scale impact, this is a chance to be at the heart of how government manages technology risk. Working closely with the Technology Risk Manager, you'll help maintain the Technology Risk Framework and Technology Risk Appetite, coordinate inputs from departments and central teams, and turn complex information into clear, well-organised products.

You'll work across organisational boundaries, acting as a reliable coordination point and helping the team deliver at pace and to a high standard.

As Technology Risk Advisor - Framework & Risk Appetite you'll:

Framework & Risk Appetite Support: Support the development and maintenance of the Technology Risk Framework and Technology Risk Appetite, including documentation, evidence gathering, stakeholder engagement and version control.

Technology Risk Group support: Support the operation of the Technology Risk Group, including preparing agendas, coordinating papers, tracking actions and helping ensure risks are presented clearly and consistently for discussion and with appropriate supporting evidence for discussion and decision-making.

Risk Research & Analysis: Conduct research and analysis on technology risk topics, supporting the identification of emerging risks, threat trends, control weaknesses and cross-government risk themes.

Stakeholder Coordination: Act as a coordination point for departments, central teams and national technical authorities, helping gather evidence, manage inputs and maintain effective working relationships.

Risk Information Management: Maintain risk trackers, action logs, dependencies and supporting datasets, ensuring information is accurate, accessible and available to support governance and decision-making.

Continuous Improvement: Support improvements to technology risk processes, documentation, reporting and governance arrangements as the Technology Risk Framework matures.

As Technology Risk Advisor - Monitoring & Advisory you ll:

Department Engagement: Support engagement with departments, helping identify barriers to effective technology risk management and supporting adoption of the Technology Risk Framework and Technology Risk Appetite.

Capability Building & Learning: Support delivery of workshops, training and peer-learning activity that improves understanding of technology risk assessment, risk treatment and technology risk governance.

Guidance & Advisory Products: Develop guidance, briefings, templates and case studies that help departments apply technology risk management approaches consistently.

Capability & Maturity Monitoring: Monitor departmental adoption of the Technology Risk Framework and Technology Risk Appetite, identifying gaps, implementation challenges, risks and opportunities for improvement.

Feedback & Insight: Collate and analyse feedback from departments, identifying common risks, implementation challenges, emerging themes and examples of good practice to support continual improvement and risk-based decision making.

Risk Research & Improvement: Conduct research on technology risk topics, threat trends and emerging issues, supporting development of guidance, capability-building products and improvement activity.

Controls & Remediation Support: Support departments to identify and implement proportionate controls, risk treatments and remediation activity, helping improve resilience and reduce the likelihood and impact of technology risks.

Please Note - The post holder may be required to support out of hours on call rotas for responding to cyber and digital resilience incidents, for which remuneration and /or flexible working arrangements will be available.

Person specification

We are interested in people who have:

experience supporting risk management, governance, programme delivery or related functions in a complex environment

the ability to manage and track multiple workstreams, actions and deadlines, keeping accurate records and trackers

confidence drafting clear written material including, minutes, briefings, templates and guidance for a range of audiences

the ability to collate, quality-check and analyse information from a range of sources and present it clearly

strong interpersonal skills and the ability to coordinate inputs from stakeholders across organisational boundaries

good attention to detail, with sound document and version-control discipline

proficiency with everyday tools such as SharePoint, Excel and collaboration software to maintain trackers and documentation

understanding of risk management concepts, including risk assessment, risk appetite, controls and mitigation

ability to gather, analyse and present information from multiple sources to support risk-based decision making

interest in technology, cyber or operational risk, including an awareness of security threats, resilience risks and technology governance, and a willingness to build knowledge of risk frameworks, appetite and governance

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King's birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

Office attendance

The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from

your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.

DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 750 words. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

- a 60 minute video interview

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is: **experience supporting risk management, governance, programme delivery or related functions in a complex environment**

In the Civil Service, we use [Success Profiles](#) to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following [Civil Service Behaviours](#):

- working together
- changing and improving
- making effective decisions
- communicating and influencing

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Cyber Capability Framework for the Risk Manager - Associate role:

- Information Risk assessment and Risk Management (Practitioner)
- Applied Security Capability (Practitioner)
- Threat Understanding (Working)
- Protective Security (Working)

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? [Click Here](#)

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: 24th August 2026

Panel interviews: Starting from 1st September 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and [the Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service
Commission

